Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 810

1. **B** Lisa

2. **C** Lisa sees that her mother has not always been as stern and strict as she is now.

3. **D** surprised

4. **C** "Lisa read through the letters voraciously. Her mother was witty and charming in the letters, teasing Daryl and citing inside jokes they had."

5. A Learning about the past can change your understanding of the present.

6. **C** She probably means that Lisa's mother had to become responsible and mature very quickly.

7. **A** Lisa's mother and father

8. **Suggested answer**: Lisa's grandmother says that Lisa's mother is so strict because she loves Lisa and Jamal so much.

9. **Suggested answer**: Answers may vary but should reflect the text. Students may respond that Lisa learns her mother was "witty and charming." Lisa also learns that her mother teased her father, made jokes, and was "full of hope."

10. **Suggested answer**: Answers may vary but should be supported by the text. Students may respond that Lisa's mother asked Lisa's grandmother to show Lisa the letters because of her love for Lisa. The letters reveal a lot about Lisa's mother. They show a side of her that has become invisible. Her decision to share that part of herself with Lisa shows that Lisa is important to her. The decision shows that she wants Lisa to know her better and to deepen their relationship.

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